Course Outline Template

Indian Institute of Management Calcutta

Programme :MBA……

Name of the Course: ……Organizing Work: Past, Present and Evolving Possibilities……

Core / Elective ……Elective…….Cap (for Elective)……45…….

Credit: 3…….

Academic Year & Term: ……Term VI, 2026-27……..

Course Coordinator: ……Prof. Nimruji Prasad J……..

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Instructor: …Nimruji Prasad J…….(Sessions …20 – …) **Affiliation:** ……IIM Calcutta…….. **Email:** IIMC id:nimruji@iimcal.ac.in	**Office hours: 1 hour on the class day.**
Instructor: …….(Sessions … – …) **Affiliation:** …….. **Email:** IIMC id:	

Introduction to Course /Course Description

Course Objective and Key-takeaways from the course

Development of formal knowledge of organization can be understood as a double movement from narrow focus on work to a broad concern with productive systems. Yet organising work has been one of the defining features of human society. Modern society is an organizational society. Even though modern corporation is the dominant form of organization, there exist several other kinds of organizations in the formal and informal space that are functioning effectively and accomplishing their work.

This course seeks to examine the various kinds of organizations that exist; the relative advantages and disadvantages of each of these kinds in accomplishing work. In studying organizations and their design, whether formal or informal, the course will interpret them as systems of coordination,

systems of control and systems of residual distribution or appropriation. Thus it goes beyond, the conventional understanding of modern day corporations and organizations as just systems of co-ordination, and some control. This implies engagement with the design of compliance, incentive and punitive systems in addition to organizational structuring. It thus deals with all kinds of alternate and emerging forms of organisations.

Objectives:

- Knowledge of different organizational arrangements in terms of their structures of co-ordination, compliance and incentive systems and appropriation systems and the implications of the same and the resultant managerial challenges.
- Organisation in the informal, formal, network and social space will be discussed.
- Equip students with the skills necessary to choose appropriate organizational arrangements for the work at hand and cope with the resultant managerial challenges.

This course will be useful for those interested in the areas of organizational design, entrepreneurship, social sector and consulting. It will also enable a critical appreciation of the function of "organization" not just as a noun but as a verb as well.

Programme Level Learning Goals (7)

Learning Goals

1. Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organisational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations

2. Develop and apply ethical values to analyse and solve organisational problems

3. Develop a global perspective that is built upon knowledge of economic, technological, regulatory and political forces that are shaping a new international order in the 21st century

4. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same

5. Be able to appreciate the dynamics of Information Technology acquisition and absorption by present day business organizations and develop ability to use modern IT enabled decision support tools for improved understanding of business

6. Acquire capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings

7. Acquire the leadership qualities and the competence needed for leading organizational change

International Components in your course (if any)

Pre-requisites

No

Required Text Book(s)

No

Recommended Text Book(s): No

Course Pack Distribution to students

Course material (if required) will also be issued from the Programme office

Technology enabled learning component for your course
(You may include if required)

Session Plan

Session	Module I : Historical Evolution of Work Organisation	Learning Objective
1	*Topics:* Course Introduction, Feudal to Industrial Society Readings: 1. Cooke (Denial of slavery in management studies 2. Jammulamadaka (2026) Modern Western Organisation as a Tool of Colonial Politics: Intersections and Erasures of Resistant Native Organising 3. E P Thompson, Time, Work-Discipline, and Industrial Capitalism, *Past and Present (1967) 38(1): 56-97* 4. Stephen A. Marglin. What Do Bosses Do?: The Origins and Functions of Hierarchy in Capitalist Production Review of Radical Political Economics July 1974	*Understanding Organisations as Systems for co-ordination, control and distribution* *Understanding emergence of formal organizational knowledge as systems of coordination*
2	Early organization in the North Atlantic/West Agriculture to Guild to Factory **1.** Ruef and Harness, "Agrarian origins of management ideology: The roman and antebellum Cases" **2.** Kieser, Alfred, (1989)"Organizational, Institutional and Societal Evolution: Medieval Craft Guilds and the Genesis of Formal Organizations" Administrative Science Quarterly, 34, 3. Managerial principles behind guild craftsmanship 4. Chapter 1-4, Perrow, Organising America	
	Module II: Person Based Systems	
3	Topic: The Indian Context, Early industrialisation in India, Difference from West Srenis and Colonial Impact Reading: Khanna, Vikramaditya, The economic history of the corporate form in ancient India Available online at http://www.law.yale.edu/documents/pdf/cbl/khanna_ancient_india_informal.pdf, 23rd October 2012 (to be uploaded on courseweb).	Understanding guild structure as an organizing mechanism
4	Topic: Professions Case: Dabbawalas Reading: 1. Pamela S. Tolbert Review of the book The System of Professions: An Essay on the Division of Expert Labor, ILR Collection at DigitalCommons@ILR. 2. Ernest Greenwood (1957) Attributes of a Profession,Social Work, (uploaded on courseweb) 3. Harvard Business School and the making of a profession	Understanding profession/occupation structure as an organizing mechanism
	Module III: Network Systems	

5	Topic: Craft Organisation Discussion on Instructor pptn of "Craft Matters" by Soumya Venkatesan 1. Stinchcombe, Arthur (1959) Bureaucratic and Craft Admininstration of Production: A Comparative Study, Administrative Science Quarterly, 4, 168-187 2. Perrow, Charles (1967) A Basis for the comparative analysis of organizations, American Sociological Review, 32: 194-208. 3. New York's fashion industry reveals a new truth	Understanding informal network structure as an organizing mechanism
6	Topic: Personal/ individual networks Discussion on instructor pptn. : Neetha, (2004) Making of Female Breadwinners, Migration and Social networking of Women domestics in Delhi Reading: 1. Burt, The Contingent Value of Social Capital Administrative Science Quarterly, Vol. 42, No. 2 (Jun., 1997), pp. 339-365 2. Coleman, James (1988) Norms as social capital, American Journal of Sociology, 94:S95-S120 3. Castilla et.al. Social Networks in Silicon Valley, in Lee et. Al. (ed.) The Silicon Valley Edge. 4. How Community Institutions Create Economic Advantage: Jewish Diamond Merchants in New York	Understanding personal network structure as an organizing mechanism
7	Topic: Small Firm Networks Discussion on Instructor pptn. Reading: 1. Perrow "Small-firm networks" 2. A new phoenix? Modern putting-out in the modena knitwear industry, Lazerson 3.. Procter, Stephen (2005) Organizations and Organized systems: From Direct Control to Flexibility, in Ackroyd, S. et.al. (Eds.) The Oxford Handbook of Work and Organization, OUP, NY.462-484. 4. Bologna shows how business cluster can stay vibrant	Understanding small firm network structure as an organizing mechanism
	Module IV: Legal Systems and Organisation	
8	Topic: NGOs Case: Gandhi Vikas Mandali Reading: 1.Werker and Ahmed, What do Non-Governmental Organisations Do? At http://www.hbs.edu/research/pdf/08-041.pdf 2. Enjolras, Bernard, A governance-structure approach to voluntary organizatins, Nonprofit and voluntary sector quarterly	Understanding nonprofit form as an organizing mechanism
9	Topic: Co-operatives and Membership based organizations Case: Shri Mahila Gruh Udyog Lijjat Papad Reading: 1. Nimruji, Goal-Boundary Typology of Nonprofits 2. Growley et.al, Organizations of the poor: conditions for success, in Chen et.al (Eds.) Membership based organizations of the poor.	Understanding co-operative form as an organizing mechanism

10	Topic: Movements form Discussion on instructor pptn. Case: Chen, Self Employed Women's Association, in Oommen (ed.) Social Movements II: concerns of equity and security. Reading: 1. Campbell, John (2005) Where do we stand? Common Mechanisms in Organizations and social Movements Research, in Davis et.al (Eds.) Social Movements and Organisation Theory, Cambridge University Press 2. How protests become successful movements 3. Together we rise	Understanding social movement form as an organizing mechanism
11	Topic: Meta Organizations Reading: Meta Organizations	
12	Student Project: Professional Association as an organizing structure	Understanding network structure as an organizing mechanism
13	Student Presentation: Social Enterprise and Hybrid Organising	Understanding profession/occupation structure as an organizing mechanism
14	Student Presentation: Networks and Meta organization as Organizing Mechanisms	Understanding relationship between legal and organizing approaches
	Module V: Evolving Possibilities: Autonomous or Collaboration based Organizing	
15	Topic: Wikiform Case: AO3 Reading: 1. The contribution revolution	Understanding collaborative organizing
16	Topic: Open Source Form/Distributed Case : Redhat and the Linux Revolution Reading: 1. Collaboration Rules 2. Communities of Creation	Understanding collaborative organizing
17	Topic: Platform based Case: Innocentive Case: Dilli Haat Reading: Why some platforms thrive	Understanding platform based organizing
18	Platform Case: India Biodiversity Portal Reading: 1. Platform organization 2.Platform ecosystem	Understanding platform based organizing
19	Topic: Collaborative Enterprise Case: Sogeti-Team Park Reading: 1. Markets, hierarchy and trust 3. Virtual organization	Understanding collaborative organizing
20	Topic: Self managed Case: Irizar in 2005 Read: 1. Miles et.al I Form Organisation	Understanding self-managed organising

	2.	
	Integration	Integrative perspective towards organsing systems

Evaluation Components

✓ Components	✓ Weightage
Class Participation (Case) (5*3) +20	35
Project	25
Assignment	15
End Term Exam	35

Online Course Management (moodle)/course web

Reference Document

Aim & Objectives of the Post Graduate Programme: The overall goal of the PGP is to produce world-class management professionals with a global perspective who are competent to lead and transform organisations anywhere in the world. . Our students would:

Learning Goals

1. **Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organisational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations**

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Attain theoretical and practical understanding of the functions and processes involved in managing an organization b. Develop critical thinking ability through analytical treatment of important contemporary problems and issues c. Acquire the ability to design approaches and use relevant models and tools to analyse situations and solve practical business problems d. Acquire the ability to persuasively recommend managerial solutions issuing from the process of decision analysis applied on managerial situation/s e. Acquire the ability to present a structured analysis of managerial situation/s using various strands of interpretations

2. Develop and apply ethical values to analyse and solve organisational problems

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Understand the realm of ethics (morality, values, ethos) and its importance to society b. Understand the issues of ethical importance specific to the domain of business c. Understand the role of manager/leader as an ethical individual and as a professional d. Understand the need and importance of institutionalizing Ethics within the organization e. Develop an understanding of corporation's duty to all the stakeholders f. Acquire the ability to appreciate the necessity of ethical practices for sustainable growth and profitability

3. Develop a global perspective that is built upon knowledge of economic, technological, regulatory and political forces that are shaping a new international order in the 21st century

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Familiarize with global factors/phenomenon affecting the business scenario b. Acquire the ability to understand and comprehend issues and practices prevalent in the international arena c. Develop competence in analysing changes in international and domestic environment d. Respond to such changes through appropriate organizational decisions

4. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Acquire the ability to organize the thought process b. Demonstrate understanding of main points c. Acquire the ability to articulate the findings in a coherent and structured format to build a managerial case analysis d. Acquire the ability to customize messages/ solutions for diverse managerial situations e. Acquire the ability to deliver a professional quality formal presentation by exhibiting clarity and appropriate pace, coherent structure, credibility, effective use of visual aids, appropriate body language

5. Be able to appreciate the dynamics of Information Technology acquisition and absorption by present day business organizations and develop ability to use modern IT enabled decision support tools for improved understanding of business

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Acquire the ability to learn various IT-enabled analytical tools , techniques and methods for solving problems b. Acquire familiarity of methods for comparing different state-of-the-art computing platforms c. Acquire the ability to use appropriate analytical techniques in a case setting to identify possibilities of deploying Information Technology for competitive advantage d. Acquire competence in use of IT tools in modelling managerial decision making situations

6. Acquire capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Acquire the ability to identify organizational problems in both real life settings and through simulated situations b. Acquire the ability to interpret and apply knowledge of concepts c. Acquire the ability to design appropriate responses to solve identified problems by using appropriate tools, techniques & framework taught in courses d. Acquire the ability to apply structured analytical thinking to solve an organizational problem

7. Acquire the leadership qualities and the competence needed for leading organizational change

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Understand the theories of leadership b. Understand the theories of organizational change c. Demonstrate understanding of complex human issues arising from the implementation of change d. Understand individuals' and groups' behavior and motivation

Course Mapping (based on earlier data)

Goal 1	Goal 2	Goal 3	Goal 4	Goal 5	Goal 6	Goal 7
Critical Thinking	Acquiring Ethical Values	Acquiring Global Perspective	Ability to Articulate	Technological Competencies	Problem Solving	Leadership Qualities
Corporate Financial Reporting and Analysis	Human Resource Management	Marketing Management I	Managerial Communication –I	Operations Research	Organisational Behaviour- II	Risk Management
Marketing Management I	Business Ethics	Environment & Development	Managerial Communication –II	Information Technology and Systems		Strategic Management
Microeconomics		Marketing Management II				Organizational Behaviour- I
Statistics for Management						
Operations Research						
Cost Management						
Corporate Finance						
Production and Operations Management						
Indian Social Structure						
India and the World Economy						
Indian Legal System						
Macroeconomics						
Indian Economic and Political History						

Mapping for Organising Work: Past, Present and Evolving Possibilities with Programme Level Goals

Goal 1	Goal 2	Goal 3	Goal 4	Goal 5	Goal 6	Goal 7
Critical Thinking a, b, c, d, e	Acquiring Ethical Values a, b ,c ,d, e ,f	Acquiring Global Perspective a, b, c, d,	Ability to Articulate a, b, c, d, e	Technological Competencies a, b, c, d,	Problem Solving a, b, c, d,	Leadership Qualities a, b, c, d,
(b,c,e)		a			d	d